

88.2 INVERSION AFTER TIME ADVERBIALS

Inversion can be used after time adverbials that are negative or restrictive, such as “no sooner” and “never before.” This emphasizes the time at which something happens, or happened.

In this simple sentence, the subject comes before the verb.

Tina had just released an album when she starred in her first movie.



No sooner **had Tina** released an album **than** she starred in her first movie.

The subject (“Tina”) and the auxiliary verb (“had”) swap places.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Hardly had she stepped out of the car **when** fans surrounded her.



Rarely do you meet a celebrity with such talent and style.



Never before had a song reached the top of the charts so quickly.



Only sometimes does it not snow during the ski season.



88.3 INVERSION AFTER “SO” AND “NEITHER”

In order to agree with a positive statement, “be” and its subject, or an auxiliary and its subject can be inverted after “so.” For a negative statement, the same is done after “neither.” For a sentence that doesn’t have an auxiliary, “do” is used when it is inverted.

I’ve never been to China.

Neither have I.



I need to get some new clothes.

So do I.



When there is no auxiliary verb, “do” is used.

I’m excited for the party tonight.

So am I!

